

15

The Housatonic at Stockbridge

(1921)

Robert Underwood Johnson

pppp *slowly and quietly* *mp*

5 *mp*

Con - ten-ted ri - ver! in thy

9 dream - y realm The cloud - y wil - low and the

mp *ppp* *mp*

*NOTE: The small notes in the right hand may be omitted, but if played should be scarcely audible. This song was originally written as a movement in a set of pieces for orchestra, in which it was intended that the upper strings, muted, be listened to separately or sub-consciously as a kind of distant background of mists seen through the trees or over a river valley, their parts bearing little or no relation to the tonality, etc. of the tune. It is difficult to reproduce this effect with piano.

plu - my elm:.....Thou

mp

ppp

mf

f

pp *r.h.* *l.h.*

rit.

Detailed description: This system contains measures 12, 13, and 14. The vocal line starts with a half note 'plu' and a half note 'my' tied to the next measure, followed by a half note 'elm' and a dotted half note. The piano accompaniment features a complex texture with many beamed sixteenth notes in the right hand and a more rhythmic bass line. Dynamics include *mp* for the vocal, *ppp* for the piano, *mf* for the bass, and *f* for the piano. There are also markings for *pp* for the right and left hands, and *rit.* for the piano.

beau - ti - ful! From ev - 'ry dream - - y hill what

mp

pp a tempo.

ppp

Detailed description: This system contains measures 15, 16, and 17. The vocal line begins with a half note 'beau' and a half note 'ti' tied to the next measure, followed by a half note 'ful!' and a half note. The piano accompaniment consists of a steady eighth-note pattern in the right hand and a bass line with occasional chords. Dynamics include *mp* for the vocal, *pp a tempo.* for the piano, and *ppp* for the piano.

eye but wan - ders with thee at thy will,.....

Detailed description: This system contains measures 18, 19, and 20. The vocal line starts with a half note 'eye' and a half note 'but' tied to the next measure, followed by a half note 'wan' and a half note 'ders' tied to the next measure, then a half note 'with' and a half note 'thee' tied to the next measure, and finally a half note 'at' and a half note 'thy' tied to the next measure, followed by a half note 'will' and a dotted half note. The piano accompaniment features a steady eighth-note pattern in the right hand and a bass line with occasional chords. The system ends with a double bar line.

20

mp

.....Con - ten - ted ri - ver!_____

pppp

mp

23

And yet___ o - ver-shy to mask thy beau - ty from the ea - ger eye;

26

Hast thou a thought to hide___ from field___ and___ town? In some deep___

pp

cur - rent of the sun - lit brown.....

pp
mf

a little faster

.....Ah! there's a res - tive rip - ple, and the swift red leaves Sept - em - ber's

in a gradually animated way

mf

first - lings fast - er drift;..... Wouldst thou a - way, dear stream? Come, whis - per near! I al - so of _ much

f
cresc.

36

rest - ing have a fear: Let me to

ff

38

mor - row thy com - pan - ion be, By

39

fall and shal - low to thead-ven-tur-ous sea!

fff non decresc.

ppp very slowly *più ten.*

forte *Red.* *Piano* *Red.*